

Samgeet — Signing Key Backup & Release Guide

Samgeet by Sambit Maity · guide written 22 Sep 2026 · app version 1.2.0

Why this matters. Android only installs an update over an existing app if the update is signed with the **same key**. If the release keystore or its password is lost, nobody who installed Samgeet can ever update it: they would have to uninstall and reinstall, and any different app id would lose all data. Back the key up before anything else.

1. What you must keep

Item	Where it is now
Release keystore (the key itself)	<code>C:\Users\Sambit\samgeet-keys\samgeet-release.jks</code>
Key alias	<code>samgeet</code>
Keystore + key password (same value)	Inside <code>android\key.properties</code> in the project folder (git-ignored)

You need **both** the `.jks` file **and** the password. One without the other is useless.

For safety, this document deliberately does **not** contain the password, because it is stored in a public repository. Save the password in a password manager.

2. How to back it up

1. Copy the whole folder `C:\Users\Sambit\samgeet-keys\` to at least **two** places you control: for example a USB drive and a private cloud folder (Google Drive, OneDrive).
2. Open `android\key.properties`, copy the `storePassword` value and store it in a password manager (or write it down and keep it somewhere safe).
3. Never upload the `.jks` file or `key.properties` to GitHub, chat, e-mail or any public place. Git is already set to ignore `*.jks`, `*.keystore` and `android/key.properties`.

3. Restore on a new computer

1. Install Flutter and Android Studio, then clone the repo: `git clone https://github.com/loco0011/samgeet.git`
2. Copy `samgeet-release.jks` to any folder, for example `C:\Users\<you>\samgeet-keys\`.
3. Create `android\key.properties` with these four lines (fill in your real values):

```
storeFile=C:/Users/<you>/samgeet-keys/samgeet-release.jks
storePassword=<the password>
keyAlias=samgeet
keyPassword=<the same password>
```

4. Build: `flutter build apk --release`

4. Check an APK is signed with the right key

The public fingerprint (SHA-256) of the Samgeet release certificate is:

eefffe6e23d5bce65d13cb05b85cb08c3f363a8d2eb6ce9892dd7c19059fd6d7

To check any APK (uses the JDK that ships with Android Studio):

```
apksigner verify --print-certs Samgeet.apk
```

The line `certificate SHA-256 digest` must equal the value above. If it says `CN=Android Debug` the build used the debug key: `key.properties` was missing.

5. Publish a new version

1. Raise `version:` in `pubspec.yaml` (for example `1.3.0+5`). The number after `+` must always go up.
2. Run `flutter test`, then `flutter build apk --release`.
3. Commit and push to `main`.
4. On GitHub: **Releases** → **Draft a new release**, create the tag (for example `v1.3.0`), attach the APK renamed to `Samgeet.apk`, and put its SHA-256 (`sha256sum Samgeet.apk`) in the notes.

The download button on the share page and in the README points to

`https://github.com/loco0011/samgeet/releases/latest/download/Samgeet.apk`, so it always serves the newest release as long as the file is named exactly `Samgeet.apk`.

6. If the key is lost anyway

There is no way to recover it. You would sign future builds with a new key; existing users must uninstall and reinstall once (their playlists and favourites live on the phone and would be lost, so warn them in the release notes first if you can still export).